



## PROGRESS REPORT

# Gulf/UAE activities: progress report, 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-04

Edition of 2026-09-04-3 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

36 countries. Each row below is carried verbatim from that country's own progress report, which answers a fixed frame of indicators over the period; nothing is written here. A country not listed under an indicator has **No evidence** on it in its own report.

**Progress values.** *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

*The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.*

## Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments

| COUNTRY | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | PROGRESS                                                         |
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| Angola  | <p>A Gulf digital memorandum in force since 2021 <a href="#">has produced no deliverable report, valuation or successor since 2023</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p><a href="#">The memorandum has been in force since December 2021, its agreed heads a three-year digitalisation master plan, public-private-partnership and build-operate-transfer financing, and youth digital skills. The telecommunications ministry attributed the national cloud implementation project to it in February 2023.</a></p> <p>Nothing has been published since. No deliverable report, valuation or successor instrument exists on the record, the memorandum text itself is not published, and the ministry's account and the vendor's are the only sources for any of it.</p> <p>The national cloud it was credited with is now in operation, reported under data storage, and no source connects the delivered system back to this memorandum.</p> | No change                                                        |
| Benin   | <p>The one Gulf instrument is a <a href="#">UAE technical cooperation memorandum signed in Cotonou on 22 March 2023</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p><a href="#">A UAE minister of state met President Talon in Cotonou on 22 March 2023 and signed a memorandum of understanding with the Beninese foreign minister to promote technical collaboration between the two foreign ministries.</a></p> <p>It carries no digital or data subject of its own on the record, and no Gulf investment, financing or data-centre commitment naming Benin is held.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | No change, a standing position the base holds for the first time |

| COUNTRY                         | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | PROGRESS                                             |
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| <b>Botswana</b>                 | <p>A <a href="#">ten-year health partnership</a> was signed in August 2026 with the operator of Abu Dhabi's health information exchange — the first Gulf instrument on the base with a named counterparty and a term.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p><a href="#">Heads of agreement with a Gulf counterparty were negotiated in March 2025 with site and technical planning progressed by September 2025; 2026-08-03 — the counterparty is not named in the operator's quarterly account.</a></p> <p>It is the only Gulf instrument the base holds for the country at any date, and the silence is the finding: the data centre it concerned is now commissioned and reporting revenue, reported under storage, with no statement of whether the agreement survived into the operating phase.</p> <p>2026-08-22 — the health ministry signed a ten-year strategic partnership with the operator of Abu Dhabi's health information exchange, for pharmaceutical and medical supply and opening cooperation on digital health transformation, genomics, precision medicine, health-sector investment and capacity development (<a href="#">signing, counterparty</a>). No sum, delivery milestone or data-custody arrangement is published — and a health-information-exchange operator entering a country building its own exchange is the part the record does not address.</p> | Advanced                                             |
| <b>Burkina Faso</b>             | <p>A Gulf memorandum <a href="#">signed in September 2025 covers artificial-intelligence skills, digital infrastructure, electronic-government consolidation and cybersecurity</a>, with nothing reported since.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2025-09-22 — <a href="#">a memorandum was signed covering artificial-intelligence skills, digital infrastructure, electronic-government consolidation and cybersecurity</a>. It is the only Gulf technology instrument the base holds, and nothing existed before it.</p> <p>No project, value, timetable or delivery has been reported in the eleven months since signature. Its four subject areas are precisely the four this report shows the state building on its own account — the roadmap, the data centres, the services portal and the security decrees — and no source connects any of that work to this memorandum.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Advanced                                             |
| <b>Burundi</b>                  | <p>One engagement is documented: <a href="#">a Qatari holding group announcing intended investment in cybersecurity, digital transformation and telecommunications</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p><a href="#">The President received a Qatari delegation from a holding group, which announced intended investment in cybersecurity, digital transformation, telecommunications and banking.</a></p> <p>That is the only documented Gulf digital or data engagement the base holds, and the finding beside it is the more useful one: no Gulf-Burundi memorandum, framework agreement or loan specifically on digital or data was located. An announced intention by a private group, received at the presidency, is what stands in for a bilateral relationship here — no instrument, no value and no follow-up is on the record.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | No change, one announced intention and no instrument |
| <b>Central African Republic</b> | <p>A Gulf memorandum <a href="#">signed at Bangui in July 2026 couples digital finance and land banking</a>, with no commitment figure, schedule or governance arrangement.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-07-31 — <a href="#">a memorandum was signed at Bangui by the minister coordinating major works and strategic investments, covering digital finance and land banking, presented as mobilising investment for infrastructure while modernising land administration, with no commitment figure, disbursement schedule, timetable or governance arrangement stated</a>. Nothing of the kind existed before it, and it is the only source under this subject the base holds; the counterparty is otherwise undocumented.</p> <p>It couples a payments ambition and a land-registry ambition under one offshore private counterparty, and registers as intent rather than finance.</p> <p>Land is the sensitive half. The country has already sold tokenised concessions with no functioning cadastre behind them, reported under the land register, and this memorandum proposes to modernise the register that sale ran ahead of.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Advanced                                             |

| COUNTRY       | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | PROGRESS                                                                       |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Comoros       | <p>No Gulf digital or telecom instrument is on file; the <a href="#">16 megawatt solar and storage microgrid is Emirati-funded</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Searched at 31 August 2026, no memorandum, investment or project with a Gulf state or a Gulf company in the digital or telecommunications sector appears in the base at either end of the window.</p> <p>What exists is adjacent. 2026-04 - a <a href="#">16 megawatt solar array with 9.1 megawatt-hours of battery storage was commissioned on Grande Comore, funded by the government of the United Arab Emirates and developed by a subsidiary of Masdar</a>. Power is a precondition for digital infrastructure and is not itself a digital commitment.</p> <p>The <a href="#">submarine cable delivered in 2016 linking Grande Comore, Anjouan and Mayotte</a> was laid by an Emirati marine contractor on other accounts; the record the base holds does not name one.</p> | No change, the one Gulf commitment in the window is energy rather than digital |
| Congo         | <p>A <a href="#">UAE Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement names the digital economy among its priority sectors</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The finance minister signed a <a href="#">Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with the UAE foreign trade minister at Abu Dhabi on 12 April 2025, alongside presidential talks at the 14th Annual Investment Forum, and named the digital economy among the free-trade area's priority sectors, undertaking to have the agreement ratified and made operational</a>.</p> <p>It is a trade and investment framework rather than a technology instrument. No Gulf sovereign-fund or telecom investment, data-centre commitment or technology memorandum naming Congo follows from it on the record.</p>                                                                                                                                                                             | No change, a standing position the base holds for the first time               |
| Cote d'Ivoire | <p><a href="#">Two non-binding memoranda signed in July 2025 have produced no work programme, deliverable or successor instrument</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2025-07-15 - two non-binding memoranda were signed, one a framework for public-administration reform and digitalisation and one for the next national digital strategy.</p> <p>Thirteen months later <a href="#">no work programme, deliverable, successor instrument or vendor presence is on file</a>. Neither memorandum has been published, so what either party undertook is not checkable, and the national digital strategy one of them was to feed has itself not appeared.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | No change                                                                      |
| Djibouti      | <p><a href="#">No Gulf-state digital investment or cooperation instrument, figure or programme is held</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The position is unchanged at both ends of the window: <a href="#">ties strengthened with one Gulf state in November 2024 are mentioned in passing in a single source, and no instrument, figure or programme is held</a>.</p> <p>It is a cited absence rather than an unexamined one. In a country whose whole external digital finance runs through three development lenders and one Chinese grant, and whose largest announced project is a memorandum with a Chinese promoter, the absence of Gulf engagement is a fact about the country's partners rather than about the base.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | No change                                                                      |
| DR Congo      | <p>The digital economy minister <a href="#">met a Gulf-based delegation on data-centre proposals in February 2026; talks only</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-02 - the minister <a href="#">met a Gulf-based delegation on data-centre proposals, with a proposed technical-specification working group and no memorandum, site, capacity or follow-up recorded six months on</a>.</p> <p>It is the whole of the relationship as the base holds it. No investment, agreement or presence has followed, and the working group that was proposed has produced nothing on record, so what is stated is an exploratory meeting rather than a commitment.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Advanced                                                                       |

| COUNTRY           | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | PROGRESS                                                                               |
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| Equatorial Guinea | <p>No Gulf digital instrument is on the record for Equatorial Guinea.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Nothing in the base names a Gulf state, sovereign fund or operator in connection with Equatoguinean digital infrastructure, financing or skills.</p> <p>The partnerships that do carry the estate are Chinese and, at proposal stage, Nigerian: the <a href="#">vendor memorandum for electronic government</a> and the <a href="#">submarine cable and data centre agreement of February 2026</a>.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | No change                                                                              |
| Eswatini          | <p>A <a href="#">women digital academy</a> was launched virtually under a bilateral memorandum signed at a United Nations General Assembly.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The academy launched in July 2026 under a memorandum signed at the 2025 General Assembly (<a href="#">academy</a>).</p> <p>No cohort size, curriculum, funding or duration is published. It is the only delivered output of any Gulf arrangement in this ledger; the other, on power for the national data centre, remains an unsigned discussion.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Advanced                                                                               |
| Ethiopia          | <p>A memorandum was signed between the two states' diplomatic academies, and technology appears as a dialogue theme rather than a commitment (<a href="#">dialogue</a>).</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The second Hili Africa Dialogue concluded in Addis Ababa in June 2026, at which a memorandum of understanding was signed between the Anwar Gargash Diplomatic Academy and Ethiopia's Institute of Foreign Affairs for research and capacity-building cooperation; its sessions discussed expanding cooperation in the digital economy and artificial intelligence (<a href="#">dialogue</a>).</p> <p>The standing bilateral position is the joint ministerial statement of 6 January 2026, which reaffirms a comprehensive strategic partnership and covers Sudan, the climate presidency and water, and names nothing digital (<a href="#">statement</a>).</p> <p>A December 2025 ambassadorial meeting explored cooperation in trade, investment, renewable energy and technology, agreeing to maintain momentum through the Joint Ministerial Commission (<a href="#">meeting</a>).</p> <p>The engagement is real and the digital instrument is not: no Gulf memorandum, investment or ministerial readout names Ethiopian digital infrastructure, artificial intelligence or payments.</p> | Advanced, on diplomatic and research cooperation rather than on any digital instrument |
| Gabon             | <p>Gabon <a href="#">renewed a memorandum with Presight, a G42 subsidiary, in Abu Dhabi in February 2026</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Presidency records three memoranda signed in Abu Dhabi – mining, digital and ports and logistics – of which the digital one renews an existing memorandum with Presight, a G42 subsidiary, to support digital transformation of the public administration and strategic state services using artificial intelligence, advanced analytics and big data, framed by the minister as consolidating Gabon's digital sovereignty.</p> <p>It is a renewal of an instrument the base did not previously hold. No amount, term, deliverable or system name is stated for it, and no Gulf investment or data-centre commitment naming Gabon is held.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Advanced                                                                               |
| Gambia            | <p>A <a href="#">Bahraini cybersecurity memorandum</a> of January 2026 and Islamic Development Bank <a href="#">financing</a> of the regional fibre backbone.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The <a href="#">memorandum with the regulator</a> offers a free critical-national-infrastructure security tier and states no value or duration, which makes it an offer of service rather than an investment.</p> <p>The <a href="#">bank's own sector page</a> records it financing the regional fibre backbone reaching The Gambia alongside two other lenders, with no date or sum given. Neither source supplies a figure, so the scale of Gulf involvement cannot be stated.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Advanced                                                                               |

| COUNTRY       | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | PROGRESS  |
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| Guinea-Bissau | <p>No Gulf state digital engagement is recorded for Guinea-Bissau.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Nothing in the base names a Gulf state, sovereign fund or operator in connection with Guinean digital infrastructure, financing or skills.</p> <p>The country's external digital financing is multilateral and regional: the <a href="#">US\$60m programme launched in August 2026</a> and the <a href="#">fund's credit facility reviews</a>.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | No change |
| Kenya         | <p><a href="#">Seven memoranda were signed with the United Arab Emirates</a> in May 2025, and consultations with Qatar were institutionalised in 2026.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Seven memoranda of understanding were signed at head-of-state level with the United Arab Emirates in May 2025 (<a href="#">signing</a>).</p> <p>Consultations in Riyadh in July 2026 addressed frameworks to support diaspora welfare, rights and economic engagement (<a href="#">consultations</a>).</p> <p>Bilateral political consultations with Qatar were institutionalised as annual in August 2026, the inaugural round led at principal secretary level (<a href="#">consultations</a>). None of the three accounts names a digital instrument, a committed amount or a project among what was agreed.</p>        | Advanced  |
| Lesotho       | <p>Labour arrangements are <a href="#">concluded with Qatar, before cabinet for the Emirates and at an advanced stage with Saudi Arabia</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-02-05 — the <a href="#">Saudi ambassador reaffirmed an airport rehabilitation commitment while presenting credentials</a>.</p> <p>2026-05-27 — <a href="#">the minister separated concluded, cabinet-pending and advanced-stage bilateral labour arrangements across the Gulf states</a>.</p> <p>2026-06-05 — <a href="#">Lesotho pitched data-centre and multi-sector investment to Dubai Chambers, arguing from its water resources for cooling</a>.</p> <p>The engagements on record are labour export and an investment pitch; no signed digital or data instrument with a Gulf state is held.</p>                          | Advanced  |
| Libya         | <p>Gulf engagement runs through two institutions: <a href="#">Arabsat</a> for satellite capacity and the <a href="#">Islamic Development Bank</a> for central bank training.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>LTT and Arabsat announced a capacity partnership on 7 August 2026, with no commercial terms published (<a href="#">partnership</a>).</p> <p>The Islamic Development Bank ran an executive programme in Jeddah in late July 2026 for central bank officials on cybersecurity and artificial-intelligence risk (<a href="#">programme</a>). No Gulf sovereign fund, hyperscaler or bilateral digital agreement is recorded, so the relationship is institutional rather than financial.</p>                                                                                                            | Advanced  |
| Madagascar    | <p>The President <a href="#">proposed a joint investment body</a> with Saudi Arabia in December 2025, covering digital governance among other sectors.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>A memorandum between an Emirati ports company and the investment board was signed in May 2024, exploratory in form with no committed amount and no named activity (<a href="#">memorandum</a>).</p> <p>The President told a Gulf newspaper in December 2025 that the country aims to launch a secure national digital platform for public administration and security drawing on Saudi experience, and proposed a joint investment body covering digital governance (<a href="#">interview</a>).</p> <p>Nothing in the base records an agreement signed, an amount committed or a project begun under either approach.</p> | Advanced  |

| COUNTRY    | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | PROGRESS  |
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| Malawi     | <p><a href="#">Five memoranda were signed during an Emirati visit in May 2025</a>, one of them on digital learning.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2025-05 - the Emirati foreign ministry's own account records <a href="#">five memoranda signed during a ministerial visit to Lilongwe</a>, one a <a href="#">digital-learning cooperation agreement between a Gulf school programme and the government</a>.</p> <p>2025-11 - Malawi <a href="#">launched a Dubai-based climate-data platform built on machine learning and distributed ledgers at the climate conference</a>.</p> <p>Both accounts come from the counterparty's side. Nothing Malawian on file states what either instrument commits the country to, what data the climate platform holds or where it holds it, and no investment figure attaches to any of it.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                             | Advanced  |
| Mali       | <p>A Gulf operator's <a href="#">US\$6bn connectivity pledge</a> for 2024 to 2026 names the country among sixteen markets, undivided between them.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The pledge was made to an international connectivity coalition in March 2024 across sixteen markets including Mali and Niger (<a href="#">pledge</a>).</p> <p>It is not broken down by country, so no Mali-specific allocation, project or delivery can be established from it. No other Gulf instrument, investment or agreement is recorded for the country.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Advanced  |
| Mauritania | <p>A <a href="#">cooperation agreement with Oman</a> was signed in July 2026 across five instruments, and the <a href="#">Islamic Development Bank</a> agreed US\$50m in principle in April.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The Omani agreement and accompanying memoranda cover digital capacity-building, electronic training, cybersecurity, artificial intelligence and data analytics, platform development and civil-service programmes, signed at the close of a Nouakchott forum with no value disclosed by either side (<a href="#">agreement</a>, <a href="#">forum</a>).</p> <p>The development bank's agreement in principle covers digital infrastructure, cybersecurity, interoperability and skills, with no signed instrument, disbursement or schedule held (<a href="#">agreement in principle</a>).</p> <p>Between them these are the largest recent commitments to the country's digital programme, and neither has a signed value on record (<a href="#">delegation</a>, <a href="#">business forum</a>).</p> | Advanced  |
| Mauritius  | <p>Cabinet approved a <a href="#">Saudi energy and cybersecurity memorandum</a> for signature in August 2026, putting digital transformation and energy-sector cybersecurity alongside hydrocarbons.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>It is an approval to sign rather than a signature, with no signing date, term, value or committed system, standard or spend (<a href="#">memorandum</a>).</p> <p>It is the only Gulf engagement on record for the country, and the digital element is bundled inside an energy instrument rather than standing on its own.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Advanced  |
| Morocco    | <p><a href="#">Twelve investment memoranda</a> span rail, energy, ports and data centres; no data centre has since been recorded proceeding under them.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The <a href="#">exchange ceremony of December 2023</a> put twelve memoranda on the record covering rail, energy, ports and data centres.</p> <p>Nothing in the base since names a data centre proceeding under any of them. Where a large facility has moved it has moved on other paper: the <a href="#">convention signed in April 2026 launching studies for a 500MW green data-centre campus at Dakhla</a>, between ministries, the region and state funds.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | No change |

| COUNTRY    | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | PROGRESS                                                                                                 |
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| Mozambique | <p>A Gulf environment memorandum <a href="#">moved past signature into a mixed technical team</a>, and a Qatari conglomerate <a href="#">signed a US\$20bn strategic agreement</a> covering six sectors.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-02-03 — the agriculture ministry <a href="#">confirmed that a memorandum with the United Arab Emirates on environment and biodiversity has moved past signature, with a mixed technical team agreed to implement its action plan</a>. It is the only Gulf instrument the base can show reaching an implementation mechanism.</p> <p>2025-08-26 — a Qatari conglomerate and the government <a href="#">signed a strategic agreement valued at US\$20bn across agriculture, energy, infrastructure, health, education and tourism</a>, the largest Gulf figure in the window. It is a private company's pledge, not a state financing instrument, and no drawdown, project or timetable is published against it.</p> <p>2026-01-14 — a bilateral business roundtable <a href="#">reviewed cooperation across trade, gas, solar energy, port expansion, agriculture and artificial intelligence</a>, the Emirati side citing bilateral trade of about US\$1.7bn in the first nine months of 2025, up 57.8 per cent. No digital-specific commitment is named in any of the three.</p> | Advanced, one memorandum reached an implementation mechanism and a much larger private pledge was signed |
| Namibia    | <p>A <a href="#">bilateral economic commission</a> with technology transfer and skills in its remit was proposed at a business forum in February 2026, with no agreement signed.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The commission's proposed remit covers technology transfer, skills development, industrialisation and manufacturing, and the Gulf side raised investment protection and double-taxation agreements; no Gulf-state digital, data-centre or artificial-intelligence agreement is published (<a href="#">proposal</a>).</p> <p>The forum's own trade list runs to diamonds, scrap metal, charcoal, frozen fish and dates, with the ask being value addition before export, which is the context the technology element sits inside.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Advanced, proposal only                                                                                  |
| Niger      | <p>A Gulf operator's <a href="#">US\$6bn connectivity pledge</a> for 2024 to 2026 names the country among sixteen markets, undivided between them.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The pledge was made to an international connectivity coalition at a mobile industry congress in March 2024 (<a href="#">pledge</a>).</p> <p>It is not divided by country and no Niger-specific project, disbursement or value is published. No state-to-state Gulf instrument is found for the country.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Advanced                                                                                                 |
| Nigeria    | <p>A <a href="#">comprehensive economic partnership agreement with the United Arab Emirates</a> was signed on 13 January 2026, the most significant Gulf instrument the base holds.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The <a href="#">agreement was signed on 13 January 2026 and explained publicly by the trade minister</a>. The agreement text is not held, and no digital or data chapter is published, so what it carries for the digital economy is unestablished.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Advanced                                                                                                 |
| Rwanda     | <p>A <a href="#">second data centre memorandum with a Gulf operator</a> was reported in August 2026, and the record does not say whether the two describe the same facility.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>Both are memoranda rather than financed builds, and both are with related entities from the same Gulf state; the record does not establish whether they describe one facility or two (<a href="#">second, first</a>).</p> <p>No capacity, site, value or timetable is stated in either. Against a country with one national data centre of unpublished capacity and no hyperscale facility, two unpriced memoranda are the whole of the forward hosting pipeline.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Advanced                                                                                                 |

| COUNTRY             | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | PROGRESS                        |
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| <b>Somalia</b>      | <p>The Council of Ministers <a href="#">terminated all agreements with the United Arab Emirates</a> in January 2026, ending port, institutional and security cooperation.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The foreign ministry announced the termination of all agreements — port operations at Berbera, Bosaso and Kismayo, federal-institution collaborations, and security and defence cooperation — on sovereignty and territorial-integrity grounds (<a href="#">announcement</a>).</p> <p>That removes the largest Gulf relationship the base held, and with it whatever digital and port-systems components sat inside those agreements; none is separately enumerated.</p> <p>What replaces it in the window is regulator-level and elsewhere: an artificial-intelligence and space regulation agreement with Saudi Arabia in September 2025 (<a href="#">agreement</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                | Regressed                       |
| <b>South Africa</b> | <p>Satellite connectivity services <a href="#">entered operation through a domestic venture and a United Arab Emirates operator</a>, framed against the national broadband programme.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>2026-06-30 — <a href="#">satellite connectivity services entered operation in Johannesburg through a domestic venture and a United Arab Emirates operator, using that operator's next-generation and broadband infrastructure, framed against the national broadband programme and rural connectivity</a>. No capacity, price, coverage or subscriber figure is published, and no licence instrument is named.</p> <p>The formal machinery of the relationship is old: <a href="#">the second session communique of the bilateral joint commission is the base's only record of it</a>, eight years before this launch, with no later session or digital workstream on file.</p> <p>So the engagement that delivered a service has no visible instrument behind it, and the instrument on record has delivered nothing this base can name.</p> | Advanced                        |
| <b>Sudan</b>        | <p>A Gulf-based processor <a href="#">signed a strategic processing agreement with a domestic bank</a> for card-sponsored digital-payment processing, formalised at a regional trade event.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The agreement covers card-network-sponsored digital payment processing and was formalised at a regional technology exhibition (<a href="#">agreement</a>).</p> <p>No value, term or volume is published. It is the only foreign commercial arrangement in the payments stack the base holds, alongside a revoked switch licence whose reported Gulf linkage the central bank never confirmed.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Advanced                        |
| <b>Zambia</b>       | <p>A <a href="#">co-operation agreement with a Qatari holding group and a joint business council with the Saudi chambers</a>, over a <a href="#">US\$1.1bn mining stake</a>.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p><a href="#">An investment of up to US\$1.1 billion for 51 per cent of a copper mining company completed is the largest Gulf commitment in the country the base holds.</a></p> <p>2025-08 — <a href="#">the state industrial corporation signed a co-operation agreement with a Qatari holding group covering energy, agriculture, tourism, mining, transport and logistics, witnessed by the President</a>.</p> <p>2025-09-18 — <a href="#">a chambers body and the Saudi chambers federation signed a memorandum establishing a joint business council</a>, an institutional channel distinct from the two deals.</p> <p>Digital and data appear in none of them. The Gulf relationship here is mining and trade.</p>                                                                                                                                  | Advanced, and not about digital |



| COUNTRY  | DEVELOPMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | PROGRESS                                                                                                             |
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| Zimbabwe | <p>An <a href="#">investment protection agreement</a> with the United Arab Emirates is ratified and gazetted; a partnership agreement due by May 2026 was still unconcluded in August.</p> <p>Full record</p> <p>The promotion and reciprocal protection of investments agreement with the United Arab Emirates was signed in June 2018, approved by the National Assembly on 29 September 2020 and the Senate on 1 October 2020, and ratified by the President on 28 November 2020 (<a href="#">instrument</a>).</p> <p>The two governments agreed in Dubai in February 2026 to conclude a comprehensive economic partnership agreement within three months, its proposed scope agriculture, mining, energy and infrastructure (<a href="#">talks</a>).</p> <p>Three months past that deadline the Emirati minister of state met the President in Harare on 10 August 2026 to discuss economy, investment and trade, and no agreement was announced (<a href="#">meeting</a>).</p> <p>The digital commitment on the base remains unsupported: a coding programme is running with the Emirates against a 1.5 million target, and the base holds no signed memorandum, value, delivery partner or enrolment figure behind it.</p> | Mixed, a ratified investment treaty standing while a partnership agreement has run past the deadline its parties set |

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## ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| EDITION         | <b>2026-09-04-3</b>                                                                                                                                                                                   |
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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.